Types of nutrients

BACKGROUND

nutrients (say 'nu-tree-ants') – substances that provide animals and plants with the energy essential for growth and life

When we eat food, our bodies use the different substances found in the food in different ways. These substances are known as **nutrients**. Human bodies need the right kinds of nutrients in the right amounts to stay healthy. The digestive system processes the food we eat. Digested nutrients are absorbed through the walls of the small intestine and then transported to all the cells through the blood in the circulatory system.

There are seven types of nutrients:

- protein
- vitamins
- minerals
- carbohydrates (which are converted into glucose)
- fibre
- fats
- water.

☞ **1** Find the words in the introduction that have an opposite meaning to the words listed below.

a) same _____

b) unhealthy _____

c) wrong _____

d) large _____

e) unknown _____

2 Write 'circulatory' or 'digestive' to complete these sentences.

a) The food we eat is processed by the _____ system.

b) Blood transports nutrients to the cells via the _____ system.

c) Blood is one part of the _____ system.

d) The small intestine is one part of the _____ system.

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Types of nutrients CONT'D

Vitamins are found in natural foods such as fruit and vegetables. The body needs vitamins to do all sorts of different jobs.



- Vitamin A helps our eyesight.
- Vitamin C keeps our immune system strong.
- Vitamin E helps keep our skin healthy.
- Vitamin D repairs our bones (and the human body can also make it from sunlight).

Humans also need **minerals**, which are found in natural foods and come from the soil and water. Examples of minerals that the body uses are iron, sodium and calcium.

3 Write the letters of the vitamins next to the jobs they do in our bodies.

a) Vitamin ___ = keeps skin healthy

b) Vitamin ___ = boosts immune system

c) Vitamin ___ = helps repair our bones

d) Vitamin ___ = helps eyesight

Humans need **fibre**, which is the stuff plant cell walls are made of. Humans also need to eat **protein** and certain **fats** in their diet to stay healthy.

4 Cross out the incorrect word from each set of brackets to complete these passages.

The human body needs (artificial / natural) foods such as fruit and vegetables. Vitamins, minerals and fibre come (form / from) these foods. Fruit and vegetables get their minerals from (soil / soiled) and water.

Humans also need (fibre / fibrous), which is the stuff plant cell walls are made of. The hard cell walls of plants are made of (cellulose / cellular), a fibre that we eat when we have (fruity / fruit) and vegetables.

Humans get protein and certain (fast / fats) from meats, nuts, seeds, legumes, fish and eggs.

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Types of nutrients CONT'D

5 For each type of nutrient listed, give at least three examples of foods that contain that nutrient.

a) carbohydrates _____

b) protein _____

c) vitamins _____

d) minerals _____

e) fibre _____

f) fats _____

g) water _____

6 Each row of foods contains one item that doesn't belong. Circle the item and write why it doesn't belong with the others. Hint: Think about the type of nutrients each one contains.

a) eggs red meat banana chicken fish prawns

Why it doesn't belong: _____

_____

b) broccoli lettuce cabbage spinach potatoes parsley cauliflower

Why it doesn't belong: _____

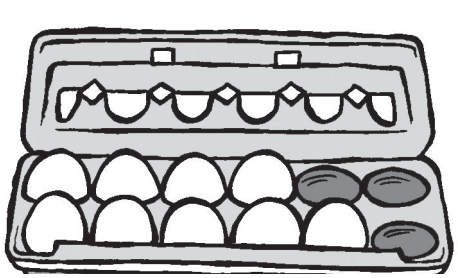
_____

c) bread butter corn cereal cracker biscuits bran muffin rice pasta

Why it doesn't belong: _____

_____





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